Rose Convery, Derrynoid Rd.;
Marie Bradley, Glenelly Villas;
Felix O'Neill, Magherafelt;
Ann Marie Mongan, Crewe, England.

**MONTH'S MIND MASS**

The Month's Mind Mass for Charlie Kelly, Moneyneena Road, will take place on Friday 16 October at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

**FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS**

The First Anniversary Mass for Michael Bradley, Disert Road, will be held on Friday 16 October at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.
The First Anniversary Mass for Kevin Kelly, Bancran Rd., will be held on Friday 23 October at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.
The First Anniversary Mass for John Joe McKenna, Cloane Rd., will be held on Friday 23 October at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary.

**ANNIVERSARIES**

**Ballinascreen:**

Dympna Kelly, Magherafelt;
Agnes Gray, Corrick Rd.;
Bridget McCloskey, Fivemilestraight;
John Donnelly, Bancran Rd.;
Sean McCullagh, Portglenone Rd.;
Anthony Rooney, Glenburn Park;
Richard Edwards, Slievegallion Drive;
John Spillane, Sixtowns Rd.;
Gerard Kelly, Sixtowns Rd.

**BAPTISMS**

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Órlaith Kearns, Sixtowns Road;
Clodagh Cassie McKenna, Disert Road;
Kajus Makaras Survilaite, Glenelly Villas;
Éanna Patrick McGillian, Bancran Road;
Katie Cobhlaith McGinn, Cranny Oaks, Omagh;
Darcai Rose O'Hagan, Carndaisy Lane, Moneymore.

**THE NATIONAL GATHERING OF THE CHURCH IN IRELAND**

Bishops, priests, religious and lay people from across Ireland will gather for the National Synodal Assembly on Saturday 17 October, to pray, listen and discern what God may be asking of the Catholic Church in Ireland at this time. Bishop Michael Router and seven delegates will represent the Diocese of Derry. Please remember Bishop Michael, our diocesan delegates and everyone taking part in your prayers. Find out more on: https://derrydiocese.org/national-synodal-assembly

**MICHAEL ENGLISH GOSPEL CONCERT THANKS**

Thank you all for joining us at our Michael English Gospel Concert. Your presence, your voices, and your joyful spirit filled the room with God's love. We are grateful for every committee member, volunteer, sponsor and guest who helped make the evening a true celebration of faith and fellowship. May the message of hope we shared continue to bless you in the days ahead.

**PARISH COLLECTIONS**

**Ballinascreen:**

Weekly Collection - £3377
Renovation Collection - £2108

**Desertmartin:**

Weekly Collection - £959.69
Renovation Collection - £514.50

Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.
Totals shown include September Standing Orders from Parishioners. If you would like to avail of this option please contact the Parish Office.

**DERRY DIOCESAN YOUNG ADULT COMMUNITY**

Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18-35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7:30 pm, starting 20 October, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org.

**CATHOLIC MARRIAGE ENCOUNTER WEEKEND**

**St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo**. **Friday 9 to Sunday 11 April 2027**. This residential Weekend starts at 7.30 pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30 pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. **Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie**

**D.D.S MASS**

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office. The fee for a living or deceased member is £20.
The following masses will be offered for the deceased members of the Derry Diocesan Society:

Tuesday 27 October at 10.00 am in St Mary's, Coolcalm;
Saturday 31 October at 6.00 pm in Holy Rosary.

**KNOCKNAGIN HALL**

**Craft Fair:** A few tables remaining for our Christmas Craft Fair! Sunday 8 November from 10:30 am to 3.00 pm. £20 per table or 2 for £30, £10 booking deposit. Email knocknaginhc@gmail.com or 078 8761 4094 to secure a table.
**Salsa Dancing for beginners:** Thursdays from 7.00 pm to 8:30 pm. No previous experience or partner needed! £42 for the 6-week block.
**Irish Class;** Mondays. ***Bunrang*** **(Beginners)** 6:45pm to 8.00 pm. **Meánrang (Improvers**) 8.00 pm to 9:30 pm.
**Chair Exercises**: Tuesdays from 10.00 am to 11.00 am. All welcome. Admission £4.
**Irish Dancing Lessons:** Tuesday evenings from 5:30 pm to 7.00 pm To register, contact Nicola: 07518 207458
**Bowling Club:** Tuesdays from 8.00 pm. Suitable for all ages. All welcome.
**Céilí Dancing Classes**: New 6-week block started on Wednesday 30 September at 7:30pm. Suitable for all ages.
**Acrobats Gymnastics Club**: Saturday mornings from 9.00 am to 2.00 pm. To register visit https://acro-bats.classforkids.io/term/10
**Sarsfield's Accordion Band:** October Monthly Draw winner: £50, Jim Higgins, Luney.
Band practice Thursdays at 7:30 pm. A Commemoration Parade, in remembrance of former band member, Christopher Bradley, will take place on Sunday 18 October at 3.00 pm, from Moorside Villas to Keenaught Chapel.

**SGARA**

**Crochet classes** start in Knocknagin hall on Tuesday 6th October at 7.30 pm to 9.00 pm all welcome limited places. Contact Chris 07546010560
**Dance in Knocknagin Hall**: Sunday 18 October from 3.00 pm to 5.30 pm. Music by Sean Corrigan.

**WHAT IS UNIVERSITY ACTUALLY FOR?**

Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy is delighted to welcome **Dr Paul Shrimpton**, writer, historian and scholar of St John Henry Newman, for a public lecture exploring Newman's vision of **human flourishing at university** - and what it might still have to say to universities and society today.
**Monday 12 October, 7.00pm** Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy, 30-38 Elmwood Avenue, Belfast. Students, staff, alumni and friends are warmly welcome. Admission free.

**LAPÓGLANN - TODDLE-INN**

Every Monday, Wednesday and Friday from 9.00 am to 10.30 am in Glór na Speiríní centre Straw, beside the Straw Church. £2 per session includes refreshments. Irish language session is every Thursday from 9.00 am to 10.30 am. Tá fáilte roimh chách All welcome! Contact conchurglor@gmail.com or 07795 536682

**CORNSTONE YOUTH CLUB**

Monday to Thursday, from 6.45 pm to 9.00 pm. Programs for all age groups. All welcome to attend at their designated nights! Registration £2, & £1 per night.

**Mondays: Years 8, 9 & 10**: Soccer, Junk Kouture, Art & ICT Club.
**Tuesdays: Years 9, 10, 11 & 12:** Duke of Edinburgh, Junk Kouture, Costume creating & Beauty.
**Wednesdays: Primary 7 & Year 8 (opt):** Sport, Art, Dance & Games.
**Thursdays: Primary 5 & 6:** Sport, Games, Art & Fun.

**MONTHLY LUNCHEON CLUB**

**Free Transport now available to Over 60s Monthly Luncheon Club in Workspace Community Hub.** Monthly Luncheon Club takes place on Wednesday 21 October in Workspace Community Hub from 11.00 am to 1.00 pm. Workspace is teaming up with Out and About Community Transport to provide free transport to anyone in the Ballinascreen area who would like to attend but doesn't have access to transport. If you would like more information on booking a free spot, please contact Workspace on 028 7962 8113 before Wednesday 14 October and join us for a delicious lunch and good company, in a warm and friendly atmosphere.

**FÉILE BHAILE NA SCRÍNE - BALLINASCREEN FESTIVAL**

**Sunday 11 October**: Family Fun Day in An Ráth Dubh from 1.00 pm to 3.00 pm. Donations at the door in aid of youth club.
For more information please contact Conchúr on 79627703 or email conchurglor@gmail.com

**SIXTOWNS CROSS COMMUNITY GROUP**

**Indoor Bowls:** Mondays at 8.15 pm. New Members Welcome.
**Christmas Fair with Santa**: Sunday 29th November 2026 at Sixtowns Hall. Tables are booking up fast. £20 per table or £30 for two. To book, contact 07769 289385

**NUALA'S BEGINNER 6 WEEK FITNESS CLASS**

Join Nuala's classes for an exciting new Beginner Fitness Class designed to help you move, build confidence, and have fun! Classes - £3.50 per session. Perfect for absolute beginners, low impact & easy to follow. Starts Tuesday 13 October from 6.45 pm to 7.45 pm in the hall, Workspace Recreation Centre on the Back row. Book your space by telephoning Carin: 02879628113.

**NETBALL FOR BEGINNERS**

Wednesday nights from 7.00 pm to 9.00 pm in the Backrow Hall. Over 16 ladies welcome. Come along for fun. No need to register Just turn up on the night. Adm £3. Contact Martina on 07795165999 for more info.

**PARISH BAPTISMS 2026**

**Ballinascreen Parish**:

All bookings to be made via Ballinascreen Parish Office on 02879628248 or Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com
Baptisms will be held at 3.00 pm on the following dates:

17 October, Sixtowns. (**Saturday**)
1 November, St. Columba's, Straw.
8 November, St Eugene's Moneyneena.
29 November, Holy Rosary Church.
6 December, St. Patrick's, Sixtowns.
13 December, St. Columba's, Straw.
20 December, St Eugene's Moneyneena.

**Desertmartin Parish:**

To book a baptism, contact Fr McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin Parish Office on 02879397047. Baptisms can be held in either church and are held at 1.30 pm on the following dates:

October 18 2026
November 8 & 22 2026
December 6 & 20 2026
January 10 & 24 2027
February 7 & 21 2027
March 7 & 14 2027
April 4 & 18 2027

**NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN**

Notices should be received by **1.00 pm on Wednesday**, preferably emailed to **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**

**PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES**

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by **1.00 pm on Wednesday** of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses should be received before **1.00 pm on Wednesday of the previous week** so that, they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend before the Anniversary Mass.

**PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS**

We pray that the men called to be priests of our diocese will know the truth of St Paul's words in our second reading, "There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength."

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https://www.cappaghparish.com

# Cappagh Parish News

*Twenty-Eighth Sunday in Ordinary Time*

*11th October 2026*

*St Mary's Killyclogher, St Mary's Knockmoyle, Corpus Christi Mountfield, Christ The King Strathroy*

## Mass Schedule

**St. Mary's Church, Killyclogher**
*Sunday Mass:* 9am & 11:15am
*Vigil:* 6.30pm (during October)
*Daily Mass:* 10am: Mon, Tues, Wed, Thurs, Fri & Sat

**Christ the King Church, Strathroy**
*Sunday Mass:* 12noon
*Evening Mass:* 7:30pm: Tues

**St. Mary's Church, Killyclogher**
*Confessions:* After Saturday morning Mass
*Confessions:* 5:45pm-6.15pm: Saturday
*Daily Rosary:* 9:10am: Monday-Saturday
*Legion of Mary:* Every Monday after 10am Mass
*Children's Liturgy Group:* 11:15am Sunday Mass in KC

**Christ the King Church, Strathroy**
*Holy Souls Prayer Group:* 1st Thurs every month

**Corpus Christi Church, Mountfield**
*Rosary:* Every Thursday at 8pm

**St. Mary's Church, Knockmoyle**
*Rosary:* Every Tuesday at 8pm, during October

## Morning Reflection Prayer for Self Confidence

Heavenly Father, Thank You for the gift of a new day.
As I begin this morning, help me to remember that my worth is found in You and not in the opinions of others or in my own doubts. Fill my heart with confidence, not pride, but the quiet assurance that I am created with purpose and loved without condition. Help me to recognise the gifts You have placed within me and give me the courage to use them wisely. When fear or insecurity tries to take hold, remind me that I do not walk alone.
Strengthen my mind, guide my words, and help me face each challenge with faith rather than worry.
Teach me to believe in the person You are shaping me to become.
May I carry myself with kindness, speak with confidence, and trust that Your plans for me are good.
Today, let me walk with peace, knowing that I am enough because I am Yours. Amen.

*Our Lady of Silence Abbey*

## Working Document for the Irish National Synodal Assembly

***17th October 2026 / Gormanston, Co Meath / "Is not this what God asks of you?" (Micah 6:8)***

The Working Document for the Irish National Synodal Assembly, brings together the fruits of five years of prayer, listening and discernment and will guide delegates as they consider and vote on suggested actions to be presented to the bishops of Ireland.

The Synodal Pathway is now moving towards a new phase of implementation. Everyone is invited to read, pray with, and reflect on the Working Document and the question: "What does God want from the Church in Ireland at this time?" Scan the QR code to access the Working Document.

Bishop Michael Router and seven delegates will represent the Diocese of Derry. Please remember Bishop Michael, our diocesan delegates and everyone taking part in your prayers. Find out more at www.derrydiocese.org/national-synodal-assembly.

**Parish Office Opening Hours: Monday –Thursday: 9am-5pm** *(closed 1-1.30pm)*
Contact: Phone 028 8224 3375 or Email info@cappaghparish.com.

**Anniversary Mass Bookings:** A Requiem Mass takes precedence and therefore your booking is subject to change. Please note that an Anniversary or Months Mind Mass may be shared with others.

**Watch Mass Live on the parish webcam:** www.cappaghparish.com
Webcam live streams only. The recording of services broadcast on the webcam ***must be requested in advance*** by contacting the parish office on 028 8224 3375 or speaking with the priest (outside of office opening hours)

**Fr Kevin McElhennon P.P:** 028 8225 8108 / k.mcelhennon@derrydiocese.org
**Fr Malachy Gallagher C.C:** 028 8225 1055 / malachy.gallagher@derrydiocese.org
**SVP CTK :** 07738838066 **SVP KC :** 07738837992

Cappagh (& Killyclogher amalgamated)

Fr John McDevitt P.P. 9376273 / 0858237119
**Fr. Karl Haan C.C. 9379107**
www.culdaffparish.com
email: culdaffnotes@gmail.com

**Daily Mass**
**Monday** 7.30 pm; **Tuesday & Wednesday**, 10 am [Blessed Sacrament Exposition after 10 am Mass until 2 pm]; **Thursday**, 7.30 pm; **Friday**, 10 am; **Saturday** 11 am.

**Confessions** Before Saturday nights Mass, 7.30 – 7.50
**Saturday Vigil 8 pm**
**Sunday 10 am.**

**Anniversary Mass this weekend**
**Saturday 8 pm** Claire Doherty, St Boden's
**Sunday 10 am** Madge McLaughlin, Drumley
.
**Next Weekend**
**Saturday Vigil 8pm** Leo McGuinness, Ballyharry

**Weekly Offering €835**
**Development Collection €275**
**We acknowledge the receipt of €90 from the Whist Club**

Envelopes can be left in McGuinness' shop.

First Reading
*Isaiah 25:6-10a*
The Lord will provide richly for his people.
Responsorial Psalm
*Psalm 23:1-6*
The Lord is our shepherd.
Second Reading
*Philippians 4:12-14,19-20*
Paul tells the Philippians that God provides whatever he needs.
Gospel Reading
*Matthew 22:1-14* (shorter form Matthew 22:1-10)

VOCATIONS - We pray that the men called to be priests of our diocese will know the truth of St Paul's words in our second reading, "There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength."

Are you 18 years or older and thinking or wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon Talk with time for Prayer, Discussion, Questions & Answers in Derry on Sunday 11 October. For further details please contact Fr Pat O'Hagan at: pgoh2111@gmail.com.

**CULDAFF TIDY TOWNS** This year's annual Culdaff Craft Fair will take place on Sunday 15 November from 2-5pm in the Wee Hall Culdaff. Afternoon teas served and a draw for valuable prizes will take place. For more information and bookings contact Philomena on 0868418189.

**Greencastle Centre** Memories & Mementoes, a scrapbooking course 6 weeks starting Thursday 22nd October 7-9pm €30.
- Strike A Chord – A Youth Music After-School Project 6 weeks starting Wednesday 14th October 4-6pm, transport & food provided.
- Autumn Wreath Workshop Thursday 15th October 7-9pm €45 msg Hayley to book 00447947431574
- Christmas Craft Fair Saturday 21st November 12pm – 3pm, stalls €20.

**Foróige** will hold an **Information Evening** on **Thursday 15th October @ 7pm in Bocan Hall** for a new Foróige Club in Culdaff for **young people aged 12-18 Years Old.** The evening is open to potential volunteers, parents and young people interested in joining the new club! All are welcome!

**A WEEKEND LIKE NO OTHER**
**Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend**
**St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo**
**Friday 9th to Sunday 11th April 2027**
This residential Weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples.
**Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie**

**SERENITY HOUSE** - Art Class Tuesday 13th October 7pm - 9pm. €60 for 8 weeks.
Mindfulness and Resilience course by Claire Doherty - Inner Balance Energy Healing. Monday 19th October 7pm-9.30pm €60 for 6 weeks.

**PRAY FOR THE NATIONAL GATHERING OF THE CHURCH IN IRELAND:** Bishops, priests, religious and lay people from across Ireland will gather for the National Synodal Assembly on Saturday, 17 October, to pray, listen and discern what God may be asking of the Catholic Church in Ireland at this time. Bishop Michael Router and seven delegates will represent the Diocese of Derry. Please remember Bishop Michael, our diocesan delegates and everyone taking part in your prayers. Find out more on: https://derrydiocese.org/national-synodal-assembly

**The Men's Shed Carn** is hosting **"DROP IN WEDNESDAYS"** for men every Wednesday from 11 am -1 pm. Pop in for a coffee and a chat and see what we do here at the shed, a place to connect, learn and create. Bring a friend, meet new people. All ages welcome
email mens.shed.carn@gmail.com or call 087 4611571.

**Carrowmenagh Community Centre Tel 074 93 67061**
There will be a **free** information session on **Making a Will** with solicitor Roisin Doherty, at the Centre on Monday, 12th October, 6.30-7.30pm. Booking required.
**Monthly Food market** starting Sunday 18th October, 2-5pm- tables only €5. To book contact the centre.
Places available on our **digital skills for farmers, plumbing, mixed media art and Kid's Halloween craft** courses. Contact the centre for more information and to book.

**Spraoi agus Spórt Activities for Children and Families**
Boogie Bugs - Mondays, 10am-12pm, ages 0-4.
Parent & Toddler Sensory Play - Tuesdays, 10am-1pm.
Mammy & Baby - Wednesdays, 10am-1pm.
Parent & Toddler Messy Play - Thursdays, 10am-1pm.
Unit 6, SuperValu, Carndonagh, F93 AY6D. Book at spraoiagussport.ie.
**Late Night Shopping Spraoi**
Come along and shop for fabulous second-hand fashion at Spraoi agus Spórt's Late Night Shopping Spraoi event at Buncrana (NEW VENUE- Scoil Mhuire) on Friday, 9 October, 6pm-9pm. Free. Skip the queues and book at spraoiagussport.ie.
**Free Baby Massage Courses**
Free 4-week baby massage courses for parents and babies from birth to pre-crawling.
Greencastle Community Centre: Wednesdays, 7–28 October, 10:30am–11:30am.
Sliabh Sneacht Centre, Drumfries: Fridays, 9 October–6 November, 10:30am–11:30am.
Free to attend. Book at spraoiagussport.ie.
**Wainfest 2026 at Spraoi**
Wainfest at Spraoi agus Spórt, Carndonagh, offers creative camps including slime-making, sewing, candle-making and gaming. Parent & Toddler sessions feature imaginative, sensory and messy play, plus support for new mothers. Events run 10th–17th October. Book at spraoiagussport.ie.
**Spraoi na Samhna**
Spraoi na Samhna at Spraoi agus Spórt, Carndonagh, offers lots of Halloween activities including a pumpkin patch, slime-making, sewing, cupcake decorating, gaming and coding camps. Parent & Toddler sessions feature sensory play, messy play and baby groups. Events run 23rd–30th October. Book at spraoiagussport.ie.

**Charities Institute Ireland Awards**
Spraoi agus Spórt has been shortlisted for three 2026 People's Choice Awards with Charities Institute Ireland. Finance Team of the Year, Fundraising Team of the Year, and Charity of the Year. Show your support by voting at https://bit.ly/4zbnAxX and enter a draw to win an Amazon Echo Dot.

**"LETTERKENNY UNIVERSITY HOSPITAL.**
Annual Service of Remembrance for Miscarriage, Still Birth, Neo-Natal death and for Children who have sadly died.
You are warmly invited to this very special Remembrance Service by the Management, Chaplaincy Dept and Staff of the hospital.
The Remembrance Service will take place in THE HOSPITAL CHAPEL.
Letterkenny University Hospital.

**Whist**
1st Margaret McGilloway
2nd Rose Thompson
3rd Bridgid McCauley
**Tickets** Sheila McCallion, Rose Thompson, Eamon Donaghy, John McLaughlin
**Jackpot** Fr Jim & Margaret McGilloway
**Other Winners** Frances Lake, Bridgid McCauley, Sheila McCallion, Eamon Donaghy & Vincent Lynn.







**The Deep End - A real royal wedding**
*by Jane Mellett*
Today's Gospel is difficult. Stories of judgement, weeping and gnashing of teeth just don't appeal much to most people. Failure to turn up to a dinner party was of course bad manners. To refuse an invite to a royal wedding was even more serious. To kill the servants or messengers who came to you with the invite…well this is pushing things a bit far. As with all parables, there is more to this than meets the eye. God wants to be in a relationship with each of us. We are all invited to his banquet. We exclude ourselves from being in fellowship with him, from his hospitality, when we give God the brush-off. We sometimes do our best to put ourselves outside of his presence. So what host would not be offended? And what about that poor chap who did come but was not suitably dressed? If we accept the invitation we should be ready for change and not just change of an outer garment. The issue for Matthew is the replacement of the unworthy in the community with those who have responded to Jesus' demands for his Kingdom. And as usual, they are not the people you would expect!

**POINTS TO PONDER**
**Complexity and perplexity**
Critics of Pope Francis have consistently maintained that Pope Francis generated confusion in the Church, whether that be at the individual level – or at the global level – the Synod and the wider synodal process.
I don't disagree that there is confusion, but I don't think Pope Francis can be blamed for it. Confusion is an unavoidable consequence of a time when unity is needed but uniformity is no longer possible.
Pope Francis did not invent this plurality; he made it impossible to ignore. The Church is no longer able, if indeed it ever was, to sustain communion by assuming cultural uniformity of a single European grammar for articulating the Gospel. It is a universal Church of diverse peoples with languages and histories, rites and cultures, joys and wounds all of their own.
This is precisely the ecclesiological horizon affirmed by the Synod's *Final Document*, which insists that 'the harmony created by the Spirit is not uniformity' and that 'the unity of the Church is not uniformity, but an organic blending of legitimate diversities.
The *Final Document* also describes the Catholic Church as a 'Church of Churches' and sees synodal renewal as fostering 'an appreciation of local contexts as the place where the universal call from God manifests and fulfils itself. Taking legitimate diversity seriously may mean introducing a measure of complexity and even perplexity into the Church.
*Eamon Conway.*